economic ones. HDI components include the basic dimensions of human development-health, knowledge and living standards. HDI, however, does not reveal the disparity of development between males and females. Therefore, keeping the same components of HDI, the UNDP formulated a **Gender Development Index** (GDI) in its Report in 1995. The GDI is the ratio of the HDIs calculated separately for females and males using the same methodology of HDI. It is a direct measure of gender gap showing the female HDI as a percentage of male HDI. Gender gap reveals the percentage of under-development of females in the three indicator areas, i.e., health, knowledge and living standards as compared to their male counterparts. A diagrammatic exposition of GDI is given in **Figure 14.1.**

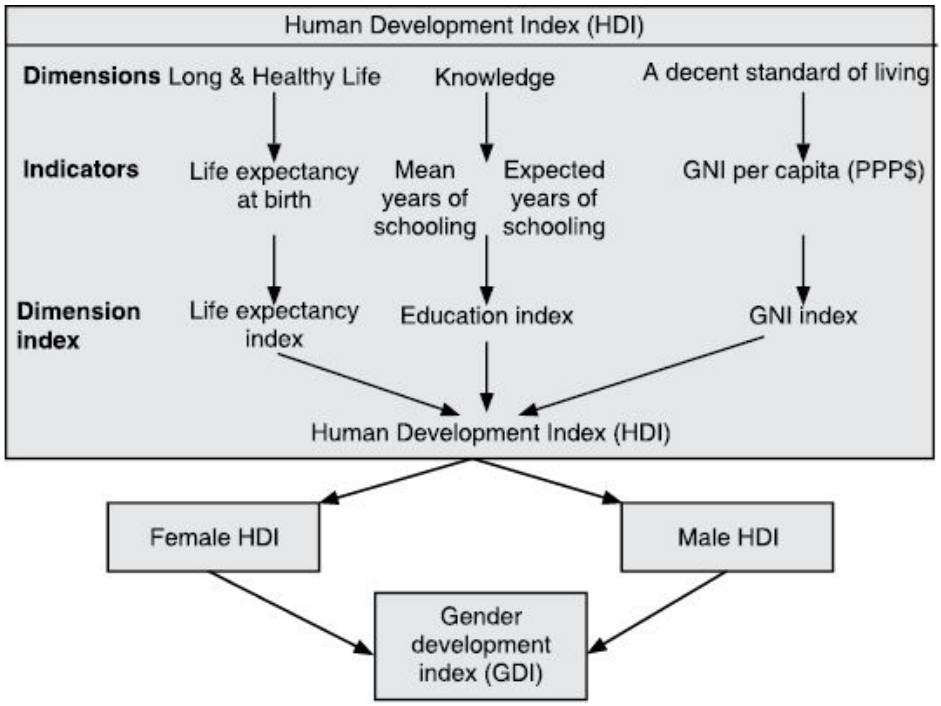


Figure 14.1 Gender Development Index (GDI).

Source: Adapted from UNDP

The GDI is calculated at present for 166 countries which are grouped into five categories based on the absolute deviation from gender parity in HDI values: [1] Very High Human Development, [2] High Human Development, [3] Medium Human Development, [4] Low Human Development and [5] Other Countries or Territories.

Along with GDI, another measure which is used to calculate gender